

Module 1 Task: Hunting the Ghost in the Machine

Format: Raw Log Analysis (JSON)

Scenario

An alert was triggered by a third-party threat intelligence feed suggesting an IP associated with the Fin7 threat group was communicating with your network. However, the automated EDR did not block anything.

Your Objective:

Analyze the provided JSON log dataset (extracted from Sysmon) to identify the entry point, the persistence mechanism, and the attacker's ultimate goal.

The Dataset

The dataset contains 500+ entries of system activity. Only 1% of it is malicious.

Part 1: Identification

1. Search the logs for any NetworkConnection events to the suspicious IP: 192.168.10.45.
2. Once you find the connection, identify the Process ID (PID) and the Image Name that made the call.
3. Why didn't the Antivirus catch this Image?

Part 2: Persistence Hunt

1. Attackers often use Scheduled Tasks or Registry Run Keys.
2. Filter the logs for ProcessCreate events involving schtasks.exe or reg.exe.
3. Identify the specific command-line used to ensure the attacker remains in the system after a reboot.

Part 3: The Payload

1. Find the ProcessCreate event for powershell.exe.
2. The command line is Base64 encoded. You must decode it (use CyberChef or Linux base64 -d) to reveal the hidden intent.

(You can use 'jq' on Linux or a JSON viewer to analyze the full file)